Introduction to Dual Language Immersion in Georgia

This presentation will:

- Provide an overview of Dual Language Immersion (DLI) in Georgia.
- Highlight the benefits of DLI for students and families.
- Describe the different DLI program models in Georgia.
- Explain how DLI programs support English Learners.
- Share the history of DLI in Georgia and showcase current programs.

What is Dual Language Immersion?

Dual Language Immersion (DLI) is an educational program in which students are taught literacy and content in two languages. The goal is to develop bilingualism, biliteracy, academic achievement, and cross-cultural competencies. It is a model that fosters high levels of proficiency in both the target language and English.

In Georgia, subjects like math and science might be taught in Spanish while social studies and English language arts are taught in English. Students have two teachers – a Spanish language teacher and an English language teacher.

A History of DLI in Georgia

- 2007 – The First DLI Charter School in Georgia was established at Unidos Dual Language School in Clayton County.
- 2008 – The first non-charter public DLI program was established at Beulah ES in Douglas County.
- 2009 – The World Language Academy was established in Hall County.
- 2013-2024 – DLI programs were established in 87 schools.

What are the benefits of DLI?

- **Cognitive Benefits**
  - Enhances problem-solving, memory, and multitasking skills.
- **Academic Advantages**
  - Students in DLI programs often perform as well as or better than their peers in traditional programs on standardized tests.
- **Language Proficiency**
  - Students achieve higher levels of proficiency in the target language compared to traditional language programs.
- **Career Readiness**
  - Provides students with skills valuable language skills for the workplace.

DLI Instructional Model (PreK-5)

Typically, instruction is divided equally between the two languages (50:50). This approach allows students to learn content and language simultaneously in both languages.

At each grade level (PreK-5), two teachers work together to share the responsibility of teaching their students across two languages.

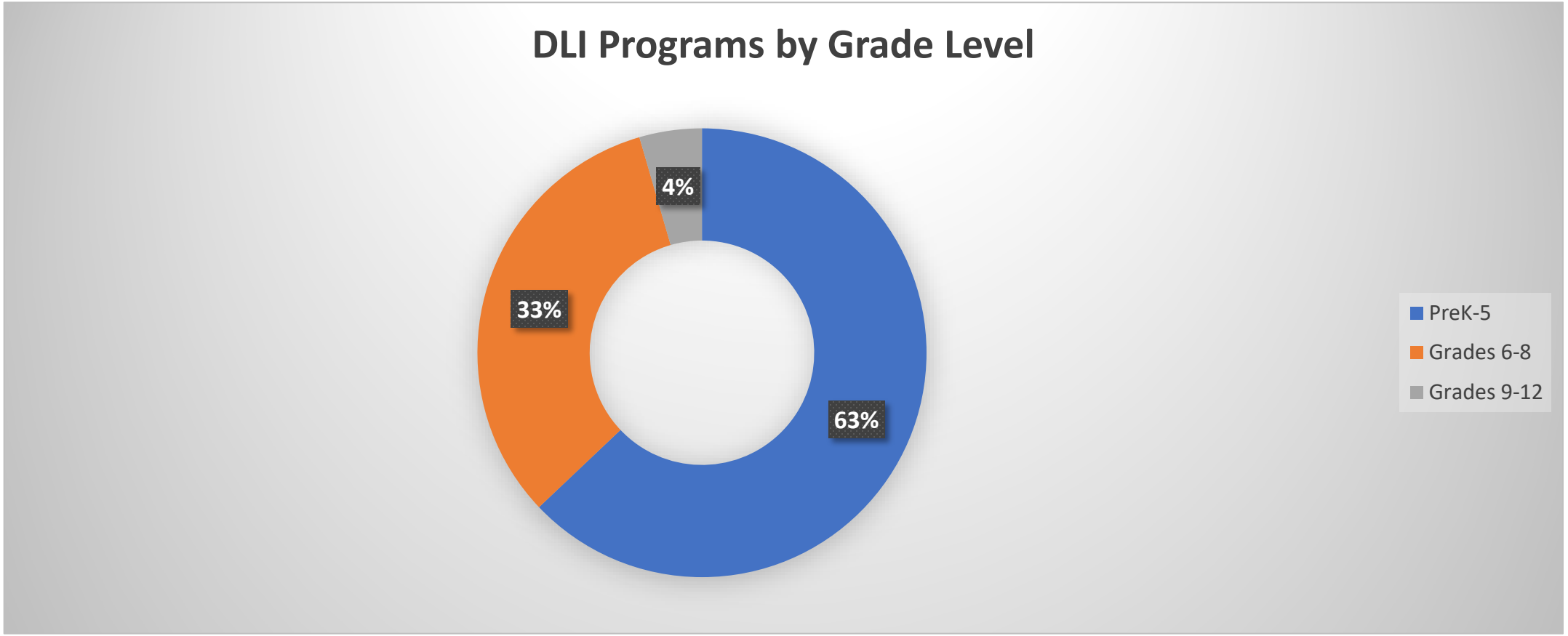
The English-side instructor teaches reading, writing, and social studies in English. The target language instructor typically teaches math, science, and literacy in the target language.

Districts may assess DLI students to determine proficiency growth in the target language.

DLI Instructional Model (6-12)

- In middle school DLI programs, students may participate in “bridge” programs with courses that focus on strengthening proficiency in the target language. Some schools offer content (such as math or science) taught in the target language.
- High school DLI continuation programs culminate in advanced coursework such as Advanced Placement or International Baccalaureate language and literature courses. Students in these programs may also be eligible to earn the Georgia Seal of Biliteracy.

DLI Programs by Grade Level



Who are the students in DLI?

In a Two-Way DLI program, students are a combination of native English speakers and native speakers of the target language in the same classroom, providing balanced exposure and interaction in both languages.

In a One-Way DLI program, most students share the same first language (usually English) and are learning a second language.

In Georgia, programs across the state provide instruction in languages like Spanish, French, German, Japanese, Korean, and Mandarin, with an emphasis on bilingualism and academic success.

What are the admission requirements for DLI programs?

The success and operation of DLI programs are determined by each Local Education Agency (LEA). They have the responsibility to create policies and procedures tailored to their community's needs while ensuring alignment with state and federal guidelines. This allows flexibility in program design, staffing, and language instruction to meet local goals.

DLI admission requirements will also vary. Families should inquire with the district or charter school in which they are interested to learn about attendance zone admissions, specialty program applications, lottery processes, etc.

How does DLI work for English Learners?

Since 2015, the DLI program has been a state-approved ESOL delivery model in Georgia (State Board of Education Rule IDDG 160-4-5-.02). Defined as “an educational delivery model whereby students learn academic content through both their native language and a foreign language”, the DLI/ESOL delivery model requires that English Learner “students participating in a DLI program receive their supplemental English language support from the teacher providing English instruction during the English portion of the academic day.”

DLI Programs in Georgia

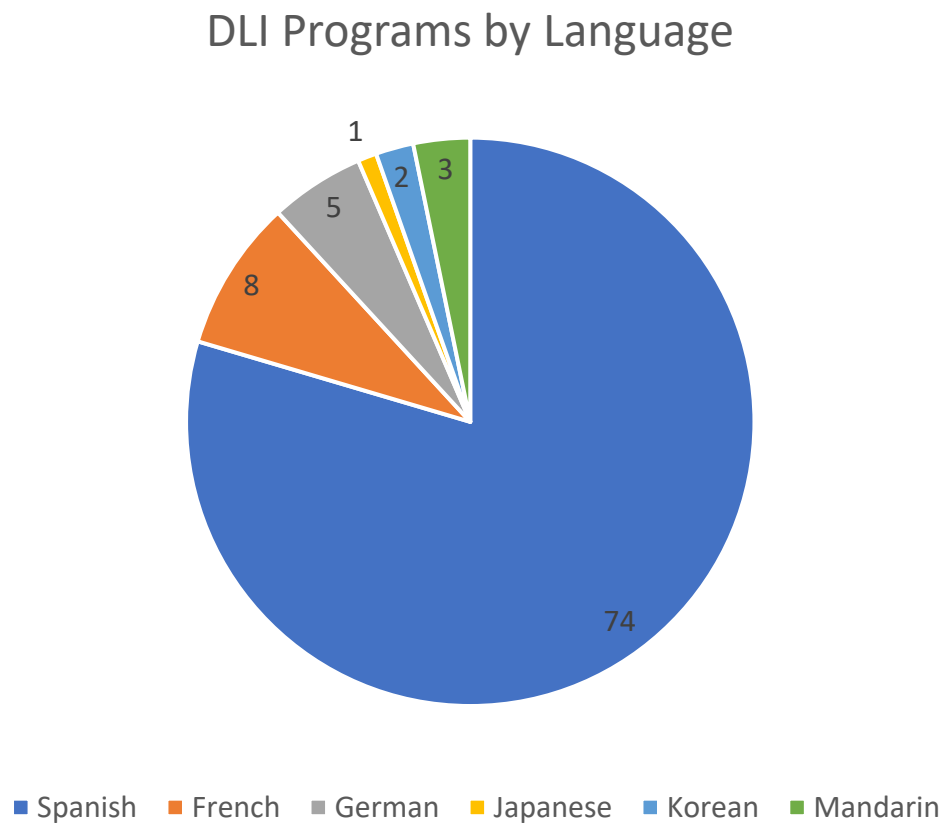
In Georgia, local districts have the flexibility to decide whether to establish DLI programs. There is no statewide mandate requiring districts of offer DLI. Each district evaluates factors such as community demand, availability of resources, and alignment with district goals.

Families interested in DLI should inquire with their local school district about program availability.

In additional to public schools, some charter schools in Georgia also offer DLI programs as part of their unique educational missions.

DLI Languages in Georgia

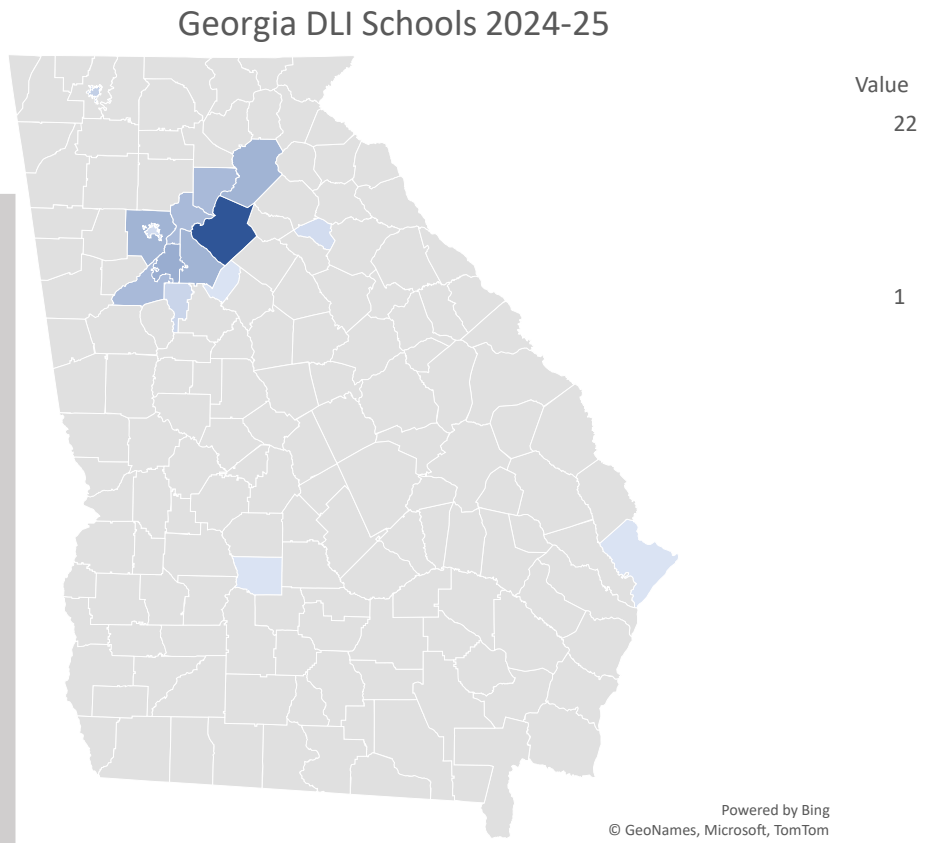
There are currently 87 schools with DLI programs in Georgia. There are program options in Spanish, French, German, Japanese, Korean, and Mandarin (Chinese). Some schools offer multiple language options and there are a total of 93 programs.



DLI Programs in Georgia

The following districts and charter schools offer DLI:

- Atlanta Public Schools
- Clarke County Schools
- Clayton County Schools
- Cobb County Schools
- Crisp County Schools
- Dalton Public Schools
- DeKalb County Schools
- Forsyth County Schools
- Fulton County Schools
- Gwinnett County Schools
- Hall County Schools
- Marietta City Schools
- Rockdale County Schools
- Savannah-Chatham County Schools
- International Charter Academy of Georgia
- International Charter School of Atlanta
- The GLOBE Academy
- Yi Hwang Academy of Language Excellence



DLI Program Details by District

Atlanta Public Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Benteen ES	Spanish	PreK-5	30315
Bolton Academy	Spanish	K-5	30318
E. Rivers ES	Spanish	K-5	30305
Garden Hills ES	Spanish	PreK-5	30305
King MS	Spanish	6	30312
Morris Brandon ES	Spanish	K-5	30327
North Atlanta HS	Spanish	9	30327
Sarah Smith ES	Spanish	PreK-5	30342
Sutton MS	Spanish	6-8	30305

Clarke County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Burney-Harris-Lyons MS	Spanish	6-8	30606
Oglethorpe Ave ES	Spanish	PreK-5	30606

Clayton County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Kilpatrick ES	Spanish	K-5	30236
Morrow MS	Spanish	6-8	30260
Unidos Dual Language School	Spanish	PreK-5	30297

DLI Program Details by District

Cobb County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Campbell HS	Spanish	9-12	30080
Campbell MS	Spanish	6-8	30080
Dowell ES	Spanish	K-5	30064
Floyd MS	Spanish	6-8	30126
Mableton ES	Spanish	K-5	30126
Nickajack ES	Spanish	K-5	30082
Russell ES	Spanish	K-5	30082
Smyrna ES	Spanish	K-5	30082

Crisp County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Crisp County Primary	Spanish	K-2	31015

Dalton Public Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Brookwood ES	German	K-5	30813
City Park ES	Spanish	PreK-1	30720
Hammond Creek MS	German	6-7	30721
Westwood ES	Spanish	PreK-4	30720

DLI Program Details by District

DeKalb County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Ashford Park ES	German	K-5	30319
Barack Obama ES	Spanish	K-5	30316
Chamblee MS	German	6-8	30341
Evansdale ES	French	K-5	30340
Henderson MS	French	6-8	30341
Pleasantdale ES	Spanish	K-5	30340
Rockbridge ES	French	K-5	30083
Stone Mountain MS	French	6-8	30083

Forsyth County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Brandywine ES	Spanish	K-5	30004
Cumming ES	Spanish	K-5	30040
DeSana MS	Spanish	6	30004
Hendricks MS	Spanish	6	30040
Kelly Mill ES	Spanish	K-5	30040
Mashburn ES	Spanish	K-4	30041
Otwell MS	Spanish	6	30040

DLI Program Details by District

Fulton County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Elkins Pointe MS	Spanish	6-7	30076
Hapeville ES	Spanish	K-5	30354
Haynes Bridge MS	Spanish	6-7	30022
Lake Forest ES	Spanish	K-5	30328
Mimosa ES	Spanish	K-5	30076
Paul D. West MS	Spanish	6	30344
Ridgeview Charter MS	Spanish	6-7	30342

Hall County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Chicopee Woods ES	Spanish	PreK	30507
Lyman Hall ES	Spanish	PreK	30504
McEver Arts Academy ES	Spanish	PreK	30504
Sandra Dunagan Deal ES	Spanish	PreK	30501
Sardis ES	Spanish	PreK	30504
Sugar Hill ES	Spanish	PreK	30506
World Language Academy ES	Spanish	PreK-5	30542
World Language Academy MS	Spanish	6-8	30507

DLI Program Details by District

Gwinnett County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Annistown ES	Spanish	K-5	30039
Baldwin ES	Spanish	K-5	30071
Bay Creek MS	French	6-8	30017
Berkmar HS	Spanish	9-10	30047
Bethesda ES	Spanish	K-5	30044
Camp Creek ES	Spanish	K-5	30047
Grayson HS	Spanish	9-10	30052
Hopkins ES	Spanish	K	30047
Ivy Creek ES	Spanish	K-5	30519
Jones MS	Spanish	6-8	30519
Level Creek ES	Spanish	K-5	30024

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Meadowcreek ES	Spanish	K-5	30093
Mulberry ES	Spanish	K-5	30011
North Gwinnett MS	Spanish	6	30518
Parsons ES	Korean	K-5	30024
Radloff MS	Spanish	6	30096
Shiloh HS	Spanish	9-10	30039
Shiloh MS	Spanish	6-8	30039
Summerour MS	Spanish	6-8	30071
Sweetwater MS	Spanish	6-8	30044
Trickum MS	Spanish	6-8	30039
Trip ES	French	K-5	30017

DLI Program Details by District

Marietta City Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Dunlieth ES	Spanish	K-5	30008
Park Street ES	Spanish	K-5	30060

Savannah-Chatham Co. Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Carrie Gould ES	Spanish	K-2	31405

Rockdale County Schools

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
C J Hicks ES	Spanish	K-5	30012

DLI Program Details – Charter Schools

International Charter Academy of Georgia

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
International Charter Academy of Georgia	Japanese	K-6	30092

International Charter School of Atlanta

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
International Charter School of Atlanta	Spanish, Chinese, French, German	K-8	30076

The GLOBE Academy

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
The GLOBE Academy	Spanish, Chinese, French	K-8	30345

Yi Hwang Academy of Language Excellence

School	Language(s)	Grades	Zip Code
Yi Hwang Academy of Language Excellence	Chinese, Korean	K-5	30096